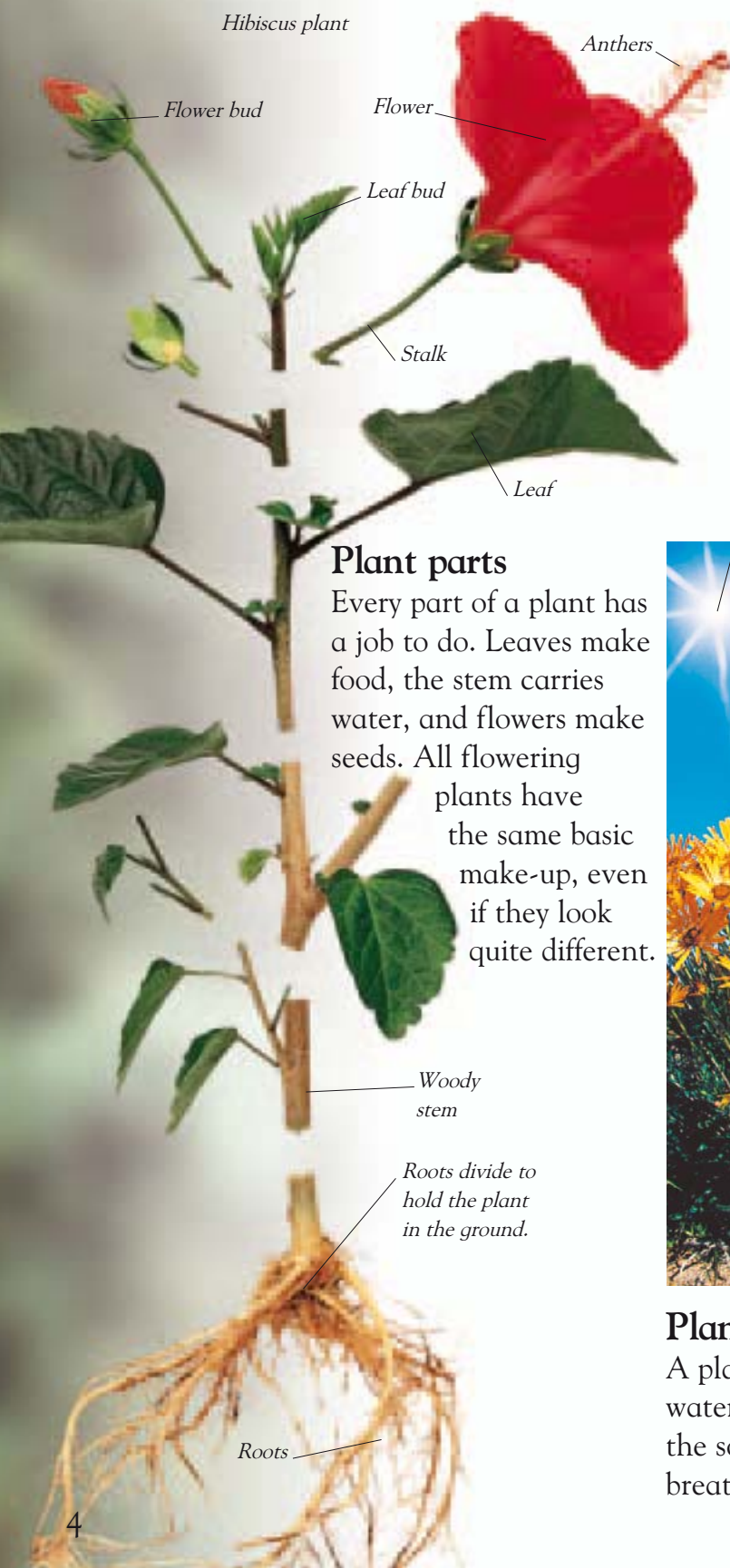


What is a plant?



Plant parts

Every part of a plant has a job to do. Leaves make food, the stem carries water, and flowers make seeds. All flowering plants have the same basic make-up, even if they look quite different.

Life on Earth is divided into plants, animals, and fungi. There are thought to be about 400,000 species of plants in the world. The first plants – algae, which live in water – appeared about 3 billion years ago.



Minerals from soil

Plant needs

A plant needs four things to survive: sunlight, water, minerals, and air. Minerals come from the soil, while air provides the gases for breathing and photosynthesis (making food).